NCCP 00321 · VERSION 9

CAPOX / XELOX

Oxaliplatin on Day 1; capecitabine twice daily on Days 1–14, followed by Days 15–21 without capecitabine. Follow your individual prescription.

Draft for clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Mouth

Capecitabine

Painful ulcers or difficulty eating and drinking: stop tablets and call.

2 Throat / breathing

Oxaliplatin

Cold can trigger throat sensations. Breathing difficulty needs assessment.

3 Chest

Capecitabine

New chest pain: stop capecitabine and seek urgent assessment.

4 Bowel

Capecitabine

Significant diarrhoea or dehydration: stop tablets and contact oncology.

5 Nerves

Oxaliplatin

Report cold sensitivity, lasting numbness or difficulty with daily tasks.

6 Hands / feet

Capecitabine

Painful redness or peeling affecting activity: stop tablets and call.

7 Blood / infection

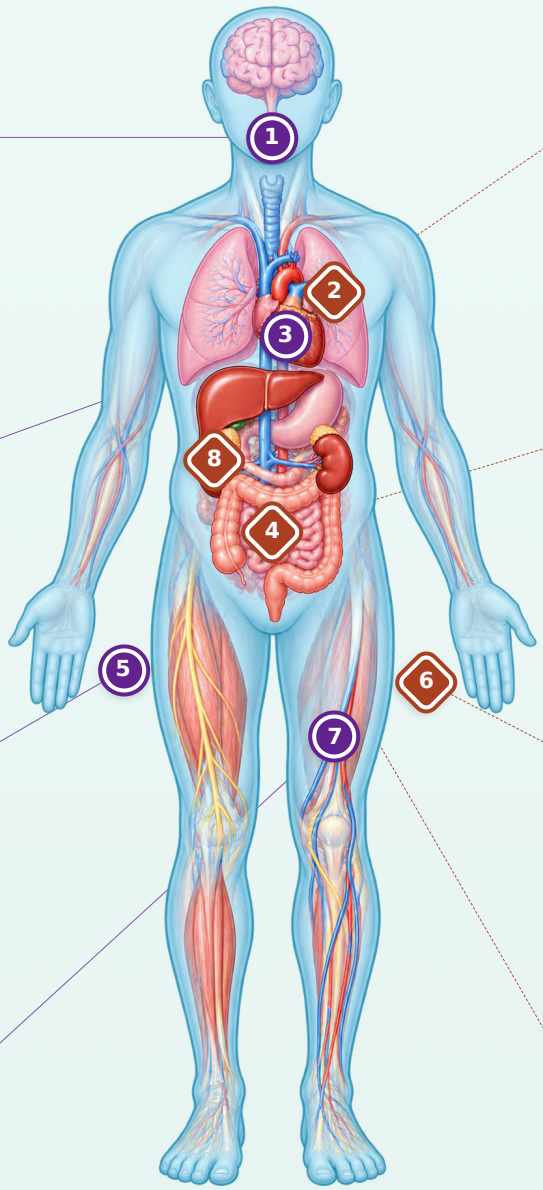
Both chemotherapy medicines

Fever, shivers or sudden illness needs immediate contact.

8 Kidneys / hydration

Capecitabine safety

Vomiting or diarrhoea can worsen kidney function. Report reduced urine.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

NCCP 00321 · PRACTICAL SUPPORT

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Capecitabine

- Diarrhoea / dehydration
- Hand-foot syndrome
- Mouth ulcers / reduced intake
- Low blood counts and infection
- Cardiotoxicity including chest pain / ischaemia
- Severe early toxicity including DPD-related toxicity
- Renal impairment and medicine interactions

Oxaliplatin

- Cold-triggered tingling / throat discomfort
- Persistent sensory neuropathy, sometimes lasting after treatment
- Allergic / infusion reaction
- Low blood counts and infection
- Nausea, diarrhoea and fatigue
- Rare serious lung or blood complications

Make the plan practical

A written tablet calendar

The dose may require different tablet strengths. Ask the pharmacist to mark the number of each strength per dose. The guide does not calculate your dose. Bring the calendar and remaining tablets to review as instructed.

DPD testing and kidney function

DPD deficiency can cause severe fluoropyrimidine toxicity. Kidney impairment can also increase exposure to capecitabine metabolites. Testing and blood monitoring support safety but do not make serious symptoms safe to ignore.

Interaction check

Tell the team about blood thinners, especially warfarin, and all new medicines. Some combinations require closer monitoring or a different plan. Ask the oncology pharmacist before starting supplements or over-the-counter medicines.

Hands, feet and cold exposure

Use gentle skin care and reduce pressure, friction and heat on sore hands and feet. Oxaliplatin can also cause cold-triggered nerve symptoms. These effects differ; report pain, numbness or functional change.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

CUH · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

087 181 9645

Acute Oncology Service

CUH · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

021 4922000

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00321/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.